

Customer & MVP Blueprint

Boutique Hotel & Restaurant — Dehradun | Based on prior Startup Validation Report

Executive Summary

The concept — a boutique hotel with an in-house restaurant in Dehradun targeting transit/leisure travelers — sits on a real market (Dehradun as a gateway to Mussoorie/Rishikesh/Haridwar) but carries **zero validated demand signal**. Before any capital commitment, the priority is a lean, low-cost validation MVP focused on testing the "easy stay" hypothesis and differentiation angle — not a full hotel build-out.

Ideal Customer Profile

Attribute	Profile
Who	Domestic leisure/transit travelers, 25–55, couples/families/small groups
Trip type	1–3 night stopovers en route to Mussoorie/Rishikesh/Haridwar
Spend band	₹2,500–5,500/night (assumption — to be confirmed)
Booking channel	OTAs (MakeMyTrip, Booking.com), Google Search, Instagram

Buyer Persona: "Convenience-Seeking Traveler"

Rohan & Priya	32 & 29, Delhi-based working couple, weekend getaway planners
Goal	Relaxed 2-night trip with minimal planning hassle
Frustration	Unreliable check-in, mediocre hotel food, misleading OTA photos
Trigger	4.3+ ratings, clear photos, good food reviews, flexible cancellation

Top 10 Customer Pain Points

- Room quality doesn't match online photos - Having to hunt for restaurants separately - Rigid check-in/check-out timing - Inconsistent service at budget hotels - Hidden fees at booking	- Poor wifi/connectivity for work-from-hills travelers - Noise/privacy issues in budget stays - Difficulty getting last-minute bookings in peak season - Limited vegetarian/regional food options - No reliable local travel/itinerary guidance from staff
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Hypothesized from industry patterns — not yet confirmed via direct customer interviews.

Customer Journey

Stage	Customer Behavior	Your Opportunity
Awareness	Searches "hotels near Mussoorie/Dehradun" on Google/OTA	SEO-optimized listing, Instagram presence, strong photos
Consideration	Compares reviews, price, photos across 4-5 options	Differentiated positioning (e.g. stay+meal combo), authentic reviews
Purchase	Books via OTA or direct call/DM	

		Frictionless booking, instant confirmation, clear cancellation policy
Retention	Returns or refers for future trips	Post-stay follow-up, loyalty offer, easy review collection

Key Customer Objections

- "No brand recognition / never heard of this place"
- "Price higher than known budget chains"
- "Too few reviews to trust at launch"
- "Uncertain about actual location vs. attractions"

Key Buying Triggers

- Planned trip to Mussoorie/Rishikesh/Haridwar with Dehradun stopover need
- Strong ratings + genuine, recent reviews
- Attractive stay+meal combo pricing
- Compelling visual content (reels/photos) of rooms & food

MVP Recommendation

Build first: A validation MVP — NOT the hotel itself. Launch a landing page/Instagram presence showcasing the concept, run a small pop-up or partner with an existing property for a pilot weekend, and collect real bookings/interest before any lease or construction.

What to Build First	Landing page + Instagram concept page; waitlist capture; 15-20 customer interviews; test combo stay+meal pricing via a pilot at a partner property
What NOT to Build	Full property construction/lease, large room inventory, elaborate restaurant menu, branded app — none of these until demand is proven
Success Metrics	≥50 waitlist sign-ups in 30 days; ≥15 completed customer interviews; ≥5 pilot bookings/pre-commitments; clear top-3 pain points identified

MoSCoW Prioritization

Must Have • Landing page & booking interest form • Clear location & concept messaging • Customer interviews (15-20)	Should Have • Instagram/social presence • Pilot partnership w/ existing property • Basic pricing test	Could Have • Sample menu tasting event • Influencer/local blogger preview stay	Won't Have (yet) • Full hotel construction • Custom booking app • Multi-property expansion plans
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Pricing Hypothesis

Mid-market positioning at **₹2,500–5,500/night** (room only) with an optional stay+breakfast or stay+dinner combo priced at a ~15-20% premium — to be tested against actual willingness-to-pay in interviews rather than assumed.

Top 5 Risks

Risk	Severity
No validated demand signal	High
High capital requirement before proof of concept	High
Seasonality of Uttarakhand tourism	Medium-High
Undifferentiated "hotel + restaurant" positioning	Medium
Founder's hospitality/F&B operating experience unconfirmed	Medium

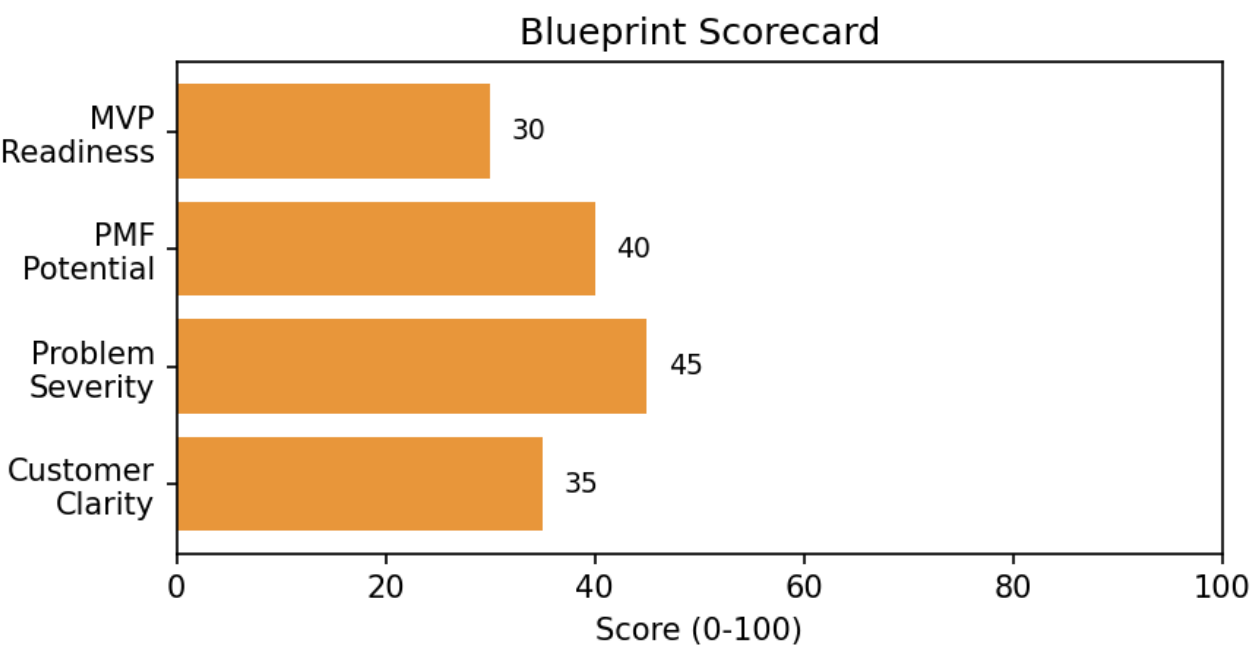
30-Day MVP Plan

Week	Focus
1	Interview 15-20 target travelers; build landing page + waitlist
2	Launch Instagram concept page; scan top 10 competitors' pricing/reviews
3	Test pricing via pilot booking offer or partner property weekend
4	Analyze waitlist + interview data; decide Go/No-Go on property search

Founder Action Sheet — Top 10 Next Actions

- 1. Interview 15-20 recent/prospective Dehradun travelers
- 2. Build a simple landing page with waitlist signup
- 3. Launch an Instagram page showcasing the concept
- 4. Map top 10 competitor hotels (price, reviews, occupancy signals)
- 5. Define your specific differentiation angle (niche/theme)
- 6. Test stay+meal combo pricing with target customers
- 7. Explore a pilot partnership with an existing property
- 8. Build a rough capex/opex financial model
- 9. Research licensing requirements (FSSAI, fire/safety, tourism dept)
- 10. Set a Go/No-Go checkpoint at Day 30 based on waitlist + interview data

Scores (0-100)



Metric	Score	Why
Customer Clarity	35	ICP defined but unvalidated with real customers
Problem Severity	45	Plausible pain points, not yet confirmed as urgent/felt
PMF Potential	40	Real market exists; differentiation not yet established
MVP Readiness	30 ●	No validation MVP launched yet; capital-heavy default plan

Final Verdict

Promising but Unvalidated

Real market opportunity exists, but customer validation must happen before any capital-intensive build begins.

This blueprint is for educational/planning purposes only and does not constitute business, financial, or investment advice. All figures are illustrative pending direct customer and market validation.